Case Study 1 - Atari

Student submission

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Worksheet link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/case-study-1-atari/as4957

Grading link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/case-study-1-atari/grading/as4957

AI disclosure: Completed; 1 entry; 0 declared AI use; 1 declared no AI use; policy v1

Game Overview

Game details

Response prompt

Identify the game: title, developer, publisher, original platform, genre, and release date. Note the version you played if different.

Submitted response

Title: International Open golf Champion
Publisher: Ocean Software Ltd.
Developer: Really Interesting Software Company(RISC)
Original Platform: PC
Release Date: 1993

History and industry

Response prompt

Explain the historical context of the release and where the game fit in the industry at that time.

Submitted response

International Open Gold Champion was released in 1993 during the time where video games were becoming better with graphics and gameplay. Golf games were becoming popular as the game allowed the players to experience sport at home on their computers. The game includes different game modes and 3d courses which made it realistic during the old era. It's also part of the sport genre but not really that famous golf game.

Contemporary comparison

Response prompt

Compare the game with a similar game from the same period, explaining a meaningful design similarity or difference.

Submitted response

Comparing with Fifa international soccer was also an sport genre game from the 1990s. Both games provided the same experience to the players on computer. However, golf mostly focused on hitting shots and choosing the power to hit while FIFA focused mostly on controlling players and scoring goals.

Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

Core gameplay mechanics

Response prompt

Explain how the core actions and rules shape a recurring player decision. Support the explanation with a gameplay example.

Submitted response

During the game player chooses the direction and power to hit each shot and requires the players to get the ball into the hole in few possible shots.

Level design

Response prompt

Explain how the layout, obstacles, or progression affect a player decision or challenge. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

During the game, the golf course layout affects how players use their shots. For example, If theres a obstacle in the way like river or water, the player should be cautious and aim precisely to avoid it. This can make the game more strategic and challenging since players must think about the right path to shoot.

Graphic And Audio Design

Visual design

Response prompt

Explain how a visual design choice affects the experience or communicates information during play. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

The game uses 3d design graphics to see the golf layout which includes the grass, trees, and hazards in the way. For example, seeing water near the hole helps make player choose a safer option to shoot.

Sound design

Response prompt

Explain how music, sound effects, or their absence affect the experience or communicate information during play. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

The games sound makes playing more entertaining and helps give feedback during the gameplay. The sound of the golf club hitting the ball helps the players feel connected to the shot. The music also makes the players feel the nostalgic retro style game.

Narrative And Storytelling

Narrative and setting

Response prompt

Explain how the setting and story relate to play. Describe key events if present, or explain the effect of a limited or absent story.

Submitted response

The game doesn't contain any types of story as the main goal is to hit few shots into the hole also the golf setting helps support players focusing on improving their skills, and trying their best to get the score.

Character development

Response prompt

Explain how character development relates to gameplay, or how limited or absent development affects the experience.

Submitted response

The game has no type of character development since the main focus is playing golf. Players focus mostly on improving their shots and getting better score.

Impact And Reception

Reception

Response prompt

Summarize the critical and player reception using identifiable reviews or feedback.
Distinguish release-era reception from later reactions.

Submitted response

An 1993 preview in Amiga Power reviewed the game mechanics and gave praises on new shot control while also including many game options but criticizing on slow performance and clutter screen. Later the website Old-games.com mostly described it as decent golf simulation with providing decent courses and useful camera views but criticized about having long term replay value.

Industry and cultural impact

Response prompt

Explain the game's industry impact and cultural significance using research. Avoid claiming influence that the sources do not establish.

Submitted response

The game contributed to the sports genre by offering 3d courses and giving different shot controls options. However, the game didn't really have any type of influence or impact on later games.

Reflection

Fun and experience

Response prompt

Explain what made the game enjoyable or frustrating for you, using a gameplay example.

Submitted response

I enjoyed when it allowed me to choose different shots and think about my shots but the only downside was when I hit the ball in water hazard which made it difficult to get a good score.

Learning and research

Response prompt

Reflect on what this case study taught you and how easy or difficult it was to find dependable information.

Submitted response

This case study taught me how the old games used gameplay and graphics to make experience more realistic during old times. The difficult part was finding the reviewers since there were only few and sources available for this game.